



Autism in Tech

Dennie Declercq // Swetugg
2020 🦋

Content

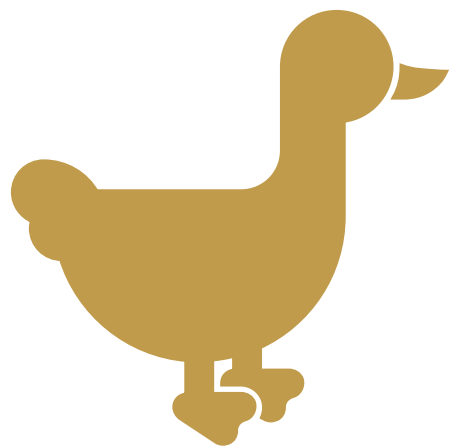
- Who am I?
- I am different
- Autism / ASD / Aspergers: Theory, myths and beyond
- Results that may appear
- Autism in tech
- Some nice 'Autistic Dennie views'
- Wrap up
- Thanks // Q&A



Who am I?

- Dennie Declercq
- DDSoft
- President / Developer
- @DennieDeclercq
- #DreamingIsBelieving





I am different



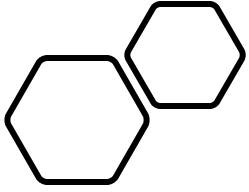
Autistic

- Different since I was a child
- Autism diagnose at age of 13
- No university college

Without a paid job

- 2008 – 2011: Tried some jobs
- No science degree
- Fabric for people with disabilities
- Tech / development in after hours
- Ended on a sickness benefit





A tech lover

- Very passionate
- Fanatic pro Microsoft
- Windows Mobile
- Why did Windows Phone die?
- Windows 3.1 → 10
- VB6 → C#

geconfronteerd worden (bvb ook bij surfen op YouTube)
: ja, er kan nooit teveel info over de maatregelen zijn
: Nee, hoe erg het ook is, verdienen mensen ook tijd voor ontspanning (alleen welliswaar)
zonder hier constant aan herinnerd moeten te worden.



How I rolled into tech world?

- 15yo: I wanted to be a developer
- Microsoft office at school
 - Microsoft Access is the beginning
- Mike was a programmer
- Don't have the feeling with PHP, JavaScript, Java
- Job offer as a volunteer developer
- Contact with Belgian community
- 2014: DDSof
- 2017: Started as conference speaker
- 2019: Microsoft MVP



Autism / ASD /
Asperger's: Theory,
Myths and beyond

DIAGNOSTIC AND STATISTICAL MANUAL OF MENTAL DISORDERS

FIFTH EDITION

DSM-5



AMERICAN PSYCHIATRIC ASSOCIATION

What is autism? (Base theory)

- A diagnosable neurodevelopmental disorder in DSM 5
- DSM: abbreviation of: “Diagnostic and Statistical Manual or Mental Disorders”
 - Official disability in most countries
 - A common approach with advices
 - There’s a local difference: ‘Aspergers in Sweden’



Communication

- Getting in contact (Other people / Authorities)
- Talking / Mailing / Messaging....
- Autism: Too much or too little
- Limited topic of interest
- Problems with eye- contact
- Too honest



Executive Functioning

- Everything that you need in daily living or in a working environment
- Examples:
 - Planning a timeslot
 - Planning what to wear at this conference
 - Planning which sessions you want to see



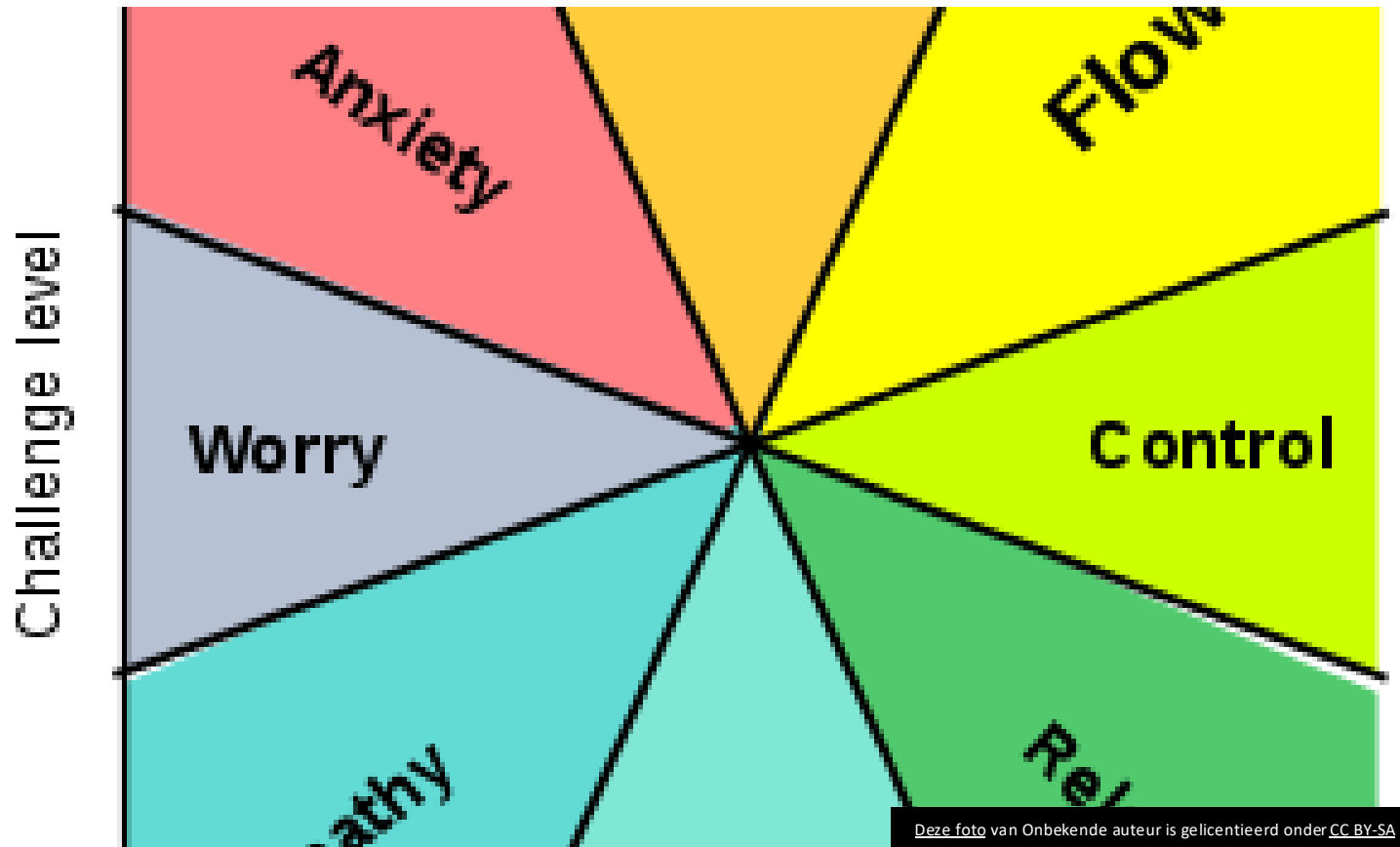
Central Coherence

- Coherence of situations, things, tasks, words
- Seeing the global picture



Context Blindness

- Understanding the context of something
- ‘One incentive has one meaning’
- Problems with ‘use of the same words for other meanings



Co-morbid diagnosis

- Extra psychological problems
 - Extra stress
 - Anxiety
 - Depression
 - ADHD

Autism / ASD: Disability or Neurodiversity?

- Thought leadership on autism changed
- People with autism / Asperger's are superpowers
- Good for inclusion
- P.w. Autism has to know their self very good.
- Example: Greta Thunberg



Paid job or volunteer job?



- Paid job is sometimes possible
- Not always
- Advice: Start with QoL “Quality of Life” and Basic comfortable feeling

Results that may
appear

Cannot cope stress

- Most people with autism
- People can get ill
- People can have communicative explosions
- Can lead into bore- or burn out



Anxiety

- - Being afraid of things they shouldn't be afraid of
- Examples: afraid to get rejected, to lose their job, and of course in IT

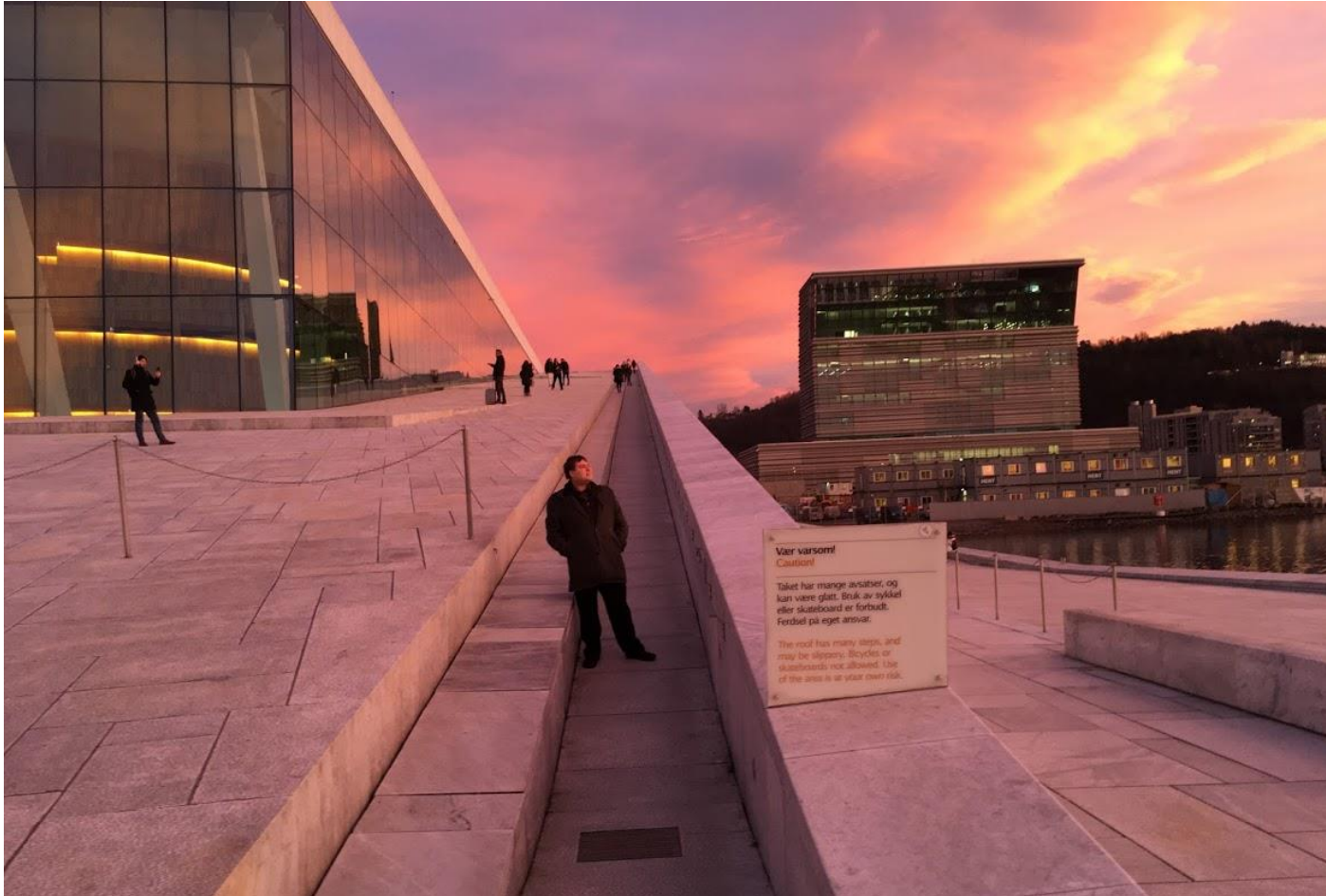


Being fanatic

- If they believe in something = they can come pretty fanatic
- The same if they are against something
- Examples: Facebook, Greta and her vision on sustainability



Different energy levels



- Being exhausted very fast
- Also getting energy from different interests

Autism in Tech

Being fanatic in tech

- Pro Microsoft / Apple / Linux?
- Difficult to use both
- C# / JavaScript
 - Me: so happy with Blazor 😊
- ASP.NET or PHP
- Biased in apps / libraries



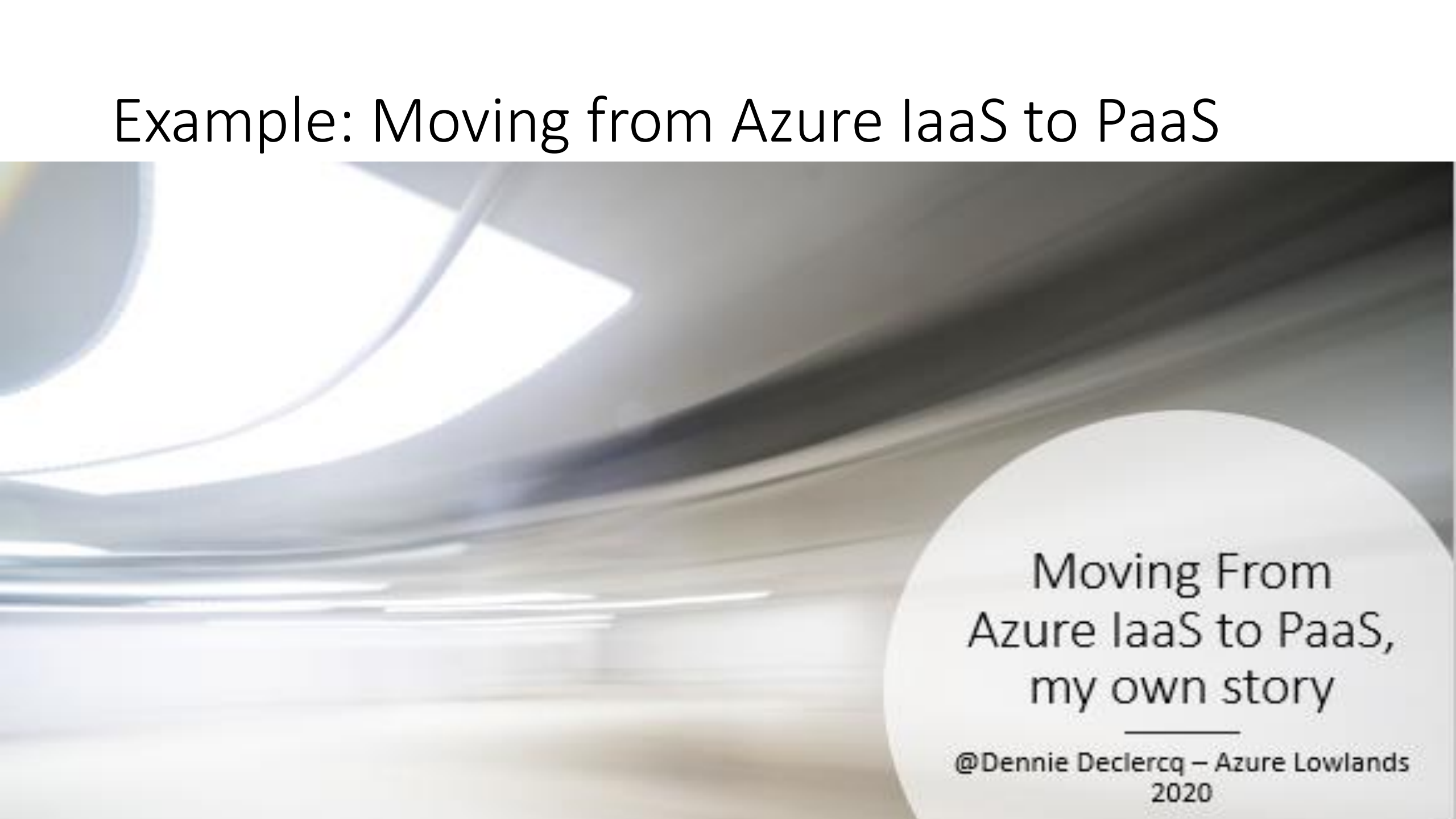


Working on updates
11% complete
Don't turn off your computer

Anxiety in tech

- Being afraid to change from tool stack
- Windows update
- Being afraid to ask questions in fora
- Being afraid to use public transport (too little time in the community)
- Cloud changes (Azure IaaS to PaaS)
- Being afraid of losing friends & Being fanatic
- Afraid of losing your job & own vision

Example: Moving from Azure IaaS to PaaS



Moving From
Azure IaaS to PaaS,
my own story

@Dennie Declercq – Azure Lowlands
2020



The latest updates?
Possible?

- Sounds difficult
- Is also difficult
- Difficult in communication
- People with autism even don't understand his own
- Not only about OS/ Business software
- -

Example:
Xamarin.Forms



NETStandard.Library v2.0.3

A set of standard .NET A...



Xamarin.Essentials by v1.2.0

Xamarin.Essentials: a kit... v1.3.1



Xamarin.Forms v4.1.0.581479

Build native UIs f... v4.4.0.991537



Different energy
and new
technology?
Possible?





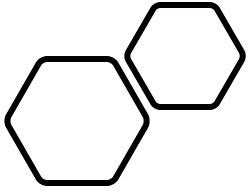
FOMO and
belonging

- Attend each conference / Meetup
- Wishlist of speakers
- Important to belong with somebody



User groups & conferences and different communication

- Talking too much or too little
- Problems with eye contact
- Different non verbal communication
 - Example: being excited but can't show



Being fanatic &
user groups and
conferences

- Can be an issue
- More difficult at
conferences
 - Variety of
topics /
speakers



Stack Exchange Q&A communities are different. Here's how:



Expert communities.

Each of our 174 communities is built by people passionate about a focused topic.



The right answer. Right on top.

Experts like you can vote on posts, so the most helpful answers are easy to find.



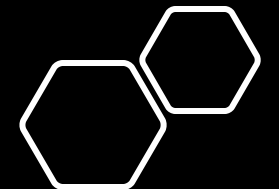
Share knowledge. Earn trust.

Earn reputation and additional privileges for posts others find helpful.

[Learn more](#)

Forums and communication

- Difficult if you are fanatic
- Forum expect knowledge and DIY
- Was difficult in the beginning





DM's and communication

Big mismatch in communication

```
private bool CheckInternetConnection()
{
    //Xamarin.Essentials: Connectivity
    var connection = Connectivity.NetworkAccess;
    if(connection == NetworkAccess.Internet)
    {
        NoConnectionButton.IsVisible = false;
        return true;
    }
    else
    {
        NoConnectionButton.IsVisible = true;
        return false;
    }
}
```

Code Style

- P.w. Autism think straight forward
 - My way of the highway
 - Can be sure they use the best classes, procedures
- Difficult to change code style
 - New possibilities in C#
 - Difficult to adapt some patterns.



Code reviews

Difficult if you have a different
code style

GitHub | DDGuard

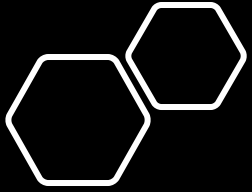
[0 Open](#) ▼ | [Create New](#)



There aren't any open pull requests

Pull requests let you tell others
about changes you've pushed to a
repository on GitHub

To get started you can [create a pull request](#)



Contributing OSS

- Can be a reason for not contributing to OSS.
- Being afraid to be different
- Afraid from criticism



Learn Git and GitHub without any code!

Using the Hello World guide, you'll create a repository, start a branch, write comments, and open a pull request.

[Read the guide](#)[Start a project](#)

davidortinau starred xamarin/MobileBlazorBindings 12 days ago

xamarin/MobileBlazorBindings

Experimental Mobile Blazor Bindings - Build native mobile apps with Blazor

 252 Updated Jan 26

 Star

davidortinau created a repository davidortinau/ThemeGallery on Dec 19, 2019

davidortinau/ThemeGallery

Updated Dec 26

 Star

davidortinau created a repository davidortinau/CarouselGallery on Nov 22, 2019

davidortinau/CarouselGallery

Reproducing a variety of carousel designs from existing apps

Updated Dec 20

 Star

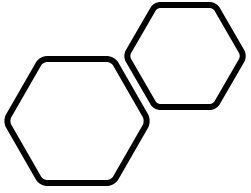
[illegible]

STRUCTURE



Day structure

- Huge change of different day structure
- More breaks during day



Special topics of interest

- Can be very fanatic for an investment
- Invest in:
 - Technology nobody cares about
 - Time in specific nice side project



Some nice 'autistic
Dennie' views



Warning: Dennie

- Not common matched with all 'auti's'



Conferences, Festivals, Artists and speakers

- I compare conferences to festivals
- Artists perform at festivals
- Speakers present at conferences
- BUT speakers are reachable!

Autistic logic & Developers logic

fx

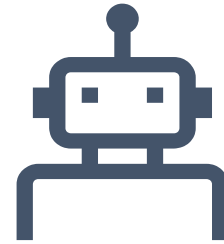
Developers Logic

A boolean is true or false

It's good to declare variables, what type it's expect

If you program a loop, the exit scenario should be clear

It's very structured



Autistic Logic

A fact is only true or false

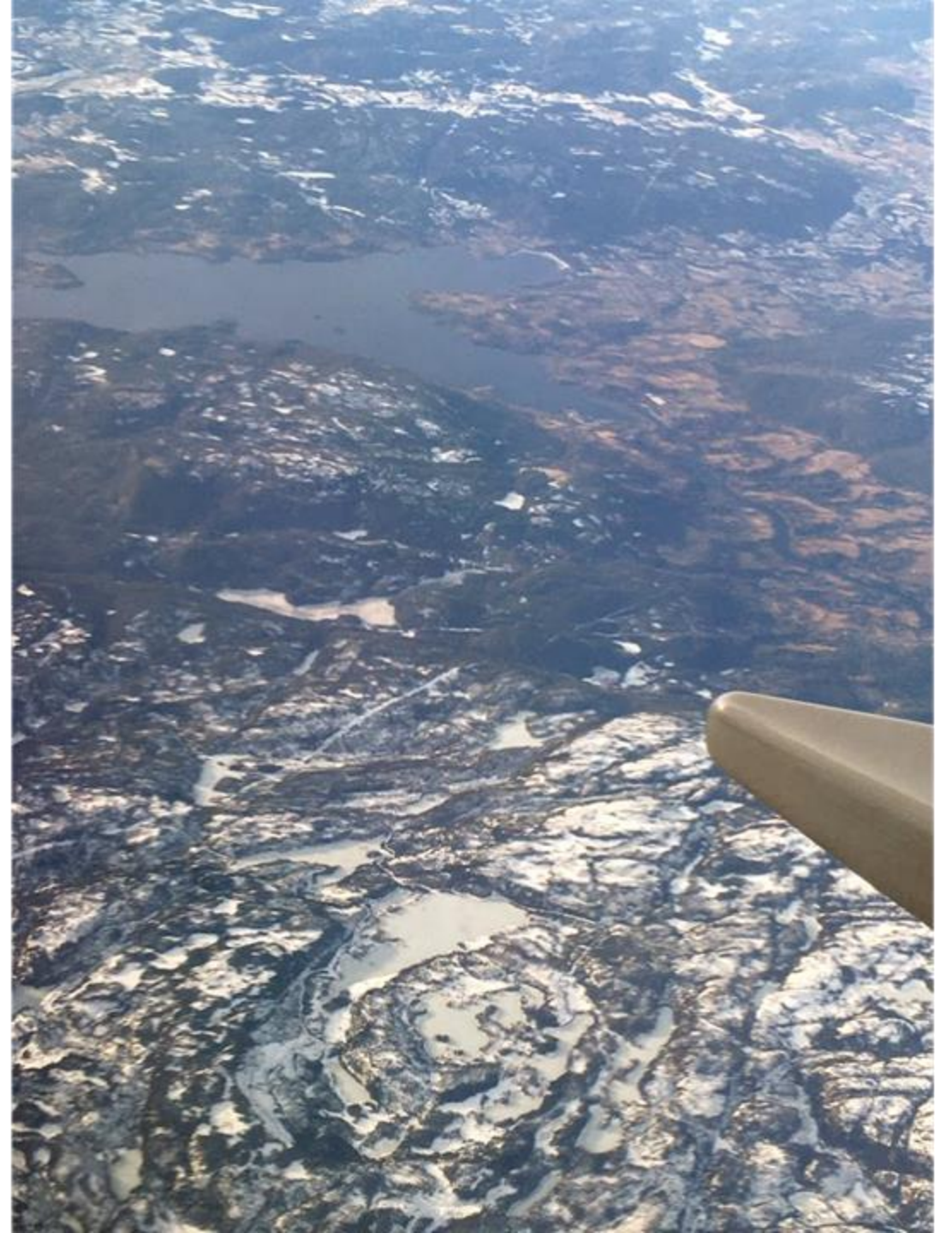
It's very nice that every circumstance is declared

If there's a path to follow, auti's like it's clear and clean

Most of them are very structured

Travel life and autism

- Is flying difficult for people with autism?
- For me flying and traveling is a lot of fun!



Speaker life and autism

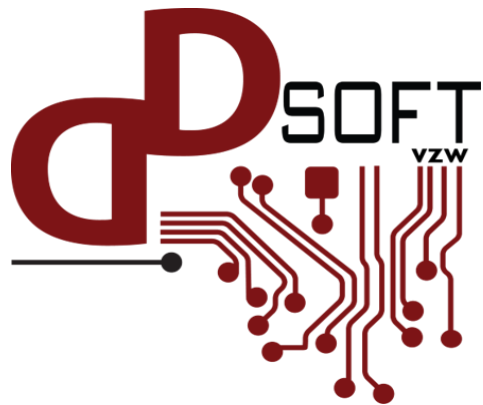
- A lot of fun!
- Feel myself very welcome
- I feel appreciated



Wrap up

Thanks! Q&A

- Dennie Declercq
- @DennieDeclercq
- #DreamingIsBelieving
- dennie@ddsoft.be



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